

PREMIUM

Refusal Decision Guide

Remonstration, judicial review, and reapplying with a stronger case

Understand your options after a refusal

Outcome	What it means	What you can do
Refusal	The consulate wasn't satisfied you met the requirements - most commonly financial evidence, a Zulassungsbescheid mismatch, or a missing APS certificate.	You can file a Remonstration, and/or reapply.
Remonstration	An internal objection filed directly with the same consulate.	Usually the first step - address the specific ground given.
Judicial review	A legal challenge at the Verwaltungsgericht Berlin, if the Remonstration doesn't succeed.	A genuine legal process, generally worth professional legal advice.
Reapplication	A new application, generally with an updated Zulassungsbescheid if enough time has passed.	The most common path - confirm with your university whether your admission is still valid.

If your Zulassungsbescheid is involved

If the refusal cites a mismatch or your intended start date has passed, contact your university's international office promptly - they may be able to confirm your admission remains valid for a later intake, or reissue documentation.

If your Sperrkonto or financial evidence was the issue

- Recheck the current published annual amount against what you actually deposited
- Confirm you used an approved Sperrkonto provider
- If relying on a sponsor or scholarship instead, confirm the letter clearly states the amount and duration

What not to do

- Don't reapply with the same evidence unchanged
- Don't omit a previous refusal on a later application
- Don't submit documents you know to be inaccurate to work around a previous refusal

When to seek professional advice

Consider consulting a German immigration lawyer if you're pursuing a Remonstrations or judicial review, or if your case involves complex academic or financial circumstances.